Pre-Flight Checklist

Before real users touch your app | SEIS 606 Project 1

Name: App: Date:

> **How to use:** Work through this on your own app. Mark each box ✓ **pass**, ✗ **fail** or **? didn't know how to check**. Every fail and ? becomes a row in your test log. Aim for at least three probes you actually ran. A documented failure earns more credit than a hidden one.

1. Secrets and source about 5 min

- ☐ Open DevTools (Sources / Network). Any API keys, tokens or passwords visible?
- ☐ View page source. Are answers, hidden scores or "admin" logic visible in client code?
- ☐ Search your repo for key, secret, token, password. Any real values committed?
- ☐ Is .env in .gitignore? Is there a .env.example with fake values?
- ☐ Check git history, not just current files. Was a secret committed once, then deleted?

2. Data and storage about 5 min

- ☐ Where does your data live: browser (localStorage), a file, or a database?
- ☐ Edit saved state in DevTools (score, level, user data) and reload. Does the app trust it?
- ☐ If there is a database: who can read and write each table? Can you query it without logging in?
- ☐ Is real personal data in your repo, seed data or screenshots?
- ☐ Is there a backup, or a way to rebuild the data from scratch?

3. Auth and access about 3 min

- ☐ Does your app need accounts? If not, write down why that is fine.
- ☐ If yes: skip the UI and hit the URL or API directly. Can you reach things you should not?
- ☐ Are any checks done only in the front end?
- ☐ Did you write your own login, or use a library or service? (Rolling your own is a red flag.)

4. Inputs and edge cases about 5 min

- ☐ Try empty input, very long input, special characters, <script> and emoji.
- ☐ Rapid-click, double-submit, refresh mid-action, use the back button.
- ☐ Uploads (if any): wrong file type, huge file, misleading file name.
- ☐ No data, bad data, slow loading: is there an error message, or a blank screen?

5. Dependencies and deployment about 4 min

- ☐ Does it run from a fresh clone using only your README? Ask a classmate to try.
- ☐ Are dependency versions pinned? Did you run an audit (npm audit, pip-audit, etc.)?
- ☐ Is debug mode off? Are error pages free of stack traces and file paths?
- ☐ Where would it run, and what happens if the free tier runs out or the service goes down?

6. AI-assisted review about 3 min

- ☐ Give your code to a different AI tool than the one you built with. Prompt it as a security or QA tester.
- ☐ For every finding, record verified, rejected or unsure, plus why.
- ☐ Did it miss something you found by hand? Did it report something that is not real?

7. Final question

What is the one thing you would fix first, and what is the one thing you could not tell was broken?

Test Log: Security Probes and Failed Checks

One row per item. Action is **fixed**, **deferred** or **won't fix**. Copy these rows into your project test log.

Category	What I tested	How	What happened	Action	Severity